

Comprehension

Reading a short passage in small pox

What is Smallpox?

Smallpox is a serious viral disease caused by the variola virus.

It mainly affected humans and was very contagious.

Smallpox has been eradicated worldwide since 1980 due to vaccination.

There are no natural cases today.

How Smallpox Spreads

Smallpox spread from person to person, mainly through:

Airborne droplets

When an infected person coughed, sneezed, or talked closely to others.

Direct contact

Touching the infected person's skin or body fluids.

Contaminated objects

Clothes, bedding, or towels used by an infected person.

It usually required close and prolonged contact to spread.

What Happens to an Infected Person?

After a person was infected, the disease followed stages:

Incubation period (7–17 days)

No symptoms

Person did not feel sick yet

Early symptoms

High fever

Headache

Body aches

Extreme tiredness

Sometimes vomiting

Rash stage

A rash appeared, starting on the face, then spreading to the body

Rash changed into fluid-filled spots over time

Spots later dried and formed scabs

Recovery or complications

Scabs eventually fell off

Many survivors were left with permanent scars

In severe cases, smallpox could be fatal

Prevention and Control

The smallpox vaccine was very effective.

Global vaccination programs led to complete eradication.

Routine vaccination is no longer needed today.

Symptoms: Fever → rash → scabs

Status: Eradicated

Prevention: Vaccination